OCTOBER 21, 2026

Tesla + SpaceX: the merger buzz, explained

THE STORY

On Oct 21 2026 Elon Musk said a Tesla SpaceX merger “would be a good idea”. Both companies have formed special committees to evaluate strategic options. Barclays has suggested a deal could emerge before Tesla’s December 6 2026 shareholder meeting. Nothing is agreed; it is talk and committees today.

TESLA Q3 2026 NUMBERS

Item	Figure	Note
Revenue	**$28.05B**	Expected about $27.9B
Adjusted EPS	**$0.48**	Expected about $0.44
Operating income	**$718M**	Down 56% year over year
Deliveries	**486,532**	
Automotive revenue	**$20.56B**	Down 3%
Services revenue	**$4.61B**	Up 33%
Free cash flow	**$1.53B**	

Stock note: the stock popped above $390 after hours, then faded back below the close.

CONTEXT

SpaceX Q3 revenue $14.58B, up 161% year over year, its first quarterly profit as a public company.

THREE KEY NUMBERS TO REMEMBER

$28.05B
Tesla revenue

56%
Operating profit drop

486,532
Tesla deliveries

WHAT TO WATCH NEXT

- Committee outcomes
- The December 6 shareholder meeting
- Tesla Q4 margins

Education only, not financial advice. Sources: Tesla Q3 2026 earnings release; reporting by CNBC, Zacks and Shacknews, Oct 21 2026.